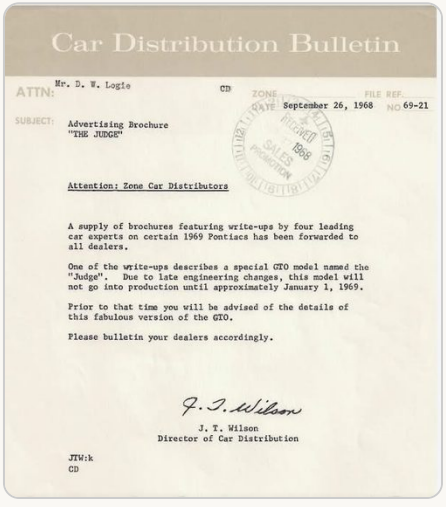
1969 GTO Judge Release Timeline from Pontiac Documents

Each entry quotes the document exactly. None of these documents names a VIN, dealer order number or dealer for a specific car.

Date	Document and quote	Image
Sep 26, 1968	**Car Distribution Bulletin 69-21, J. T. Wilson, Director of Car Distribution** “a special GTO model named the “Judge”. Due to late engineering changes, this model will not go into production until approximately January 1,	

Car Distribution Bulletin

ATTN: Mr. D. W. Logie CD

ZONE FILE REF.

DATE September 26, 1968 NO. 69-21

SUBJECT: Advertising Brochure "THE JUDGE"

Attention: Zone Car Distributors

A supply of brochures featuring write-ups by four leading car experts on certain 1969 Pontiacs has been forwarded to all dealers.

One of the write-ups describes a special GTO model named the "Judge". Due to late engineering changes, this model will not go into production until approximately January 1, 1969.

Prior to that time you will be advised of the details of this fabulous version of the GTO.

Please bulletin your dealers accordingly.

J. T. Wilson

J. T. Wilson
Director of Car Distribution

JTW:k
CD

1969.”

Tier 2 · **Documented fact**

Oct 31, 1968

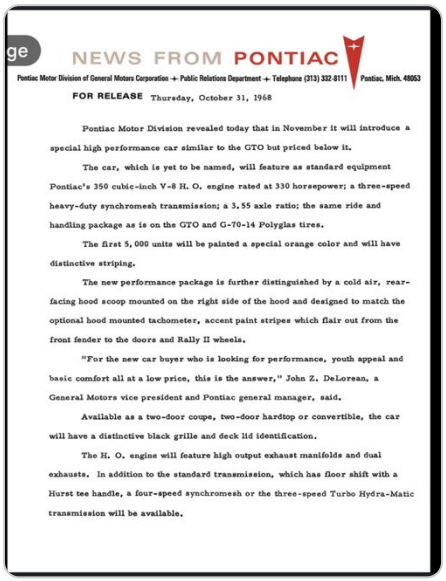
PMD Public Relations release

“The first 5,000 units will be painted a special orange color and will have distinctive striping.” (car “yet to be named,” 350 H.O. engine)

Tier 2 · **Documented fact**

That it describes a planned car, not the Judge as announced:

Corroborated interpretation



NEWS FROM PONTIAC

Pontiac Motor Division of General Motors Corporation + Public Relations Department + Telephone (313) 332-8111 Pontiac, Mich. 48053

FOR RELEASE Thursday, October 31, 1968

Pontiac Motor Division revealed today that in November it will introduce a special high performance car similar to the GTO but priced below it.

The car, which is yet to be named, will feature as standard equipment Pontiac's 350 cubic-inch V-8 H. O. engine rated at 330 horsepower; a three-speed heavy-duty synchromesh transmission; a 3.55 axle ratio; the same ride and handling package as is on the GTO and G-70-14 Polyglas tires.

The first 5,000 units will be painted a special orange color and will have distinctive striping.

The new performance package is further distinguished by a cold air, rear-facing hood scoop mounted on the right side of the hood and designed to match the optional hood mounted tachometer, accent paint stripes which flair out from the front fender to the doors and Rally II wheels.

"For the new car buyer who is looking for performance, youth appeal and basic comfort all at a low price, this is the answer," John Z. DeLorean, a General Motors vice president and Pontiac general manager, said.

Available as a two-door coupe, two-door hardtop or convertible, the car will have a distinctive black grille and deck lid identification.

The H. O. engine will feature high output exhaust manifolds and dual exhausts. In addition to the standard transmission, which has floor shift with a Hurst tee handle, a four-speed synchromesh or the three-speed Turbo Hydra-Matic transmission will be available.

That it describes a planned car, not the Judge as announced:

Corroborated interpretation

Dec 11, 1968

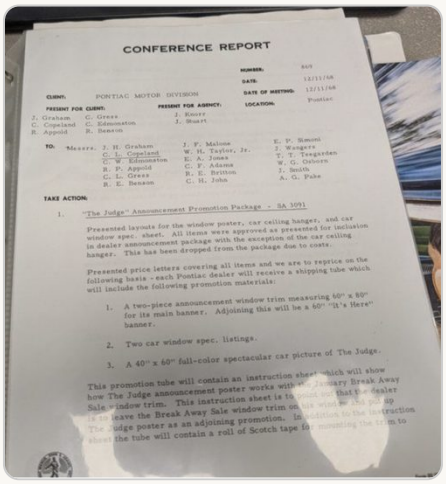
Agency Conference Report No. 869 (client: Pontiac Motor Division)

“‘The Judge’ Announcement Promotion Package - SA 3091”

Tier 4 · Lead, auction listing photograph, original not examined

Photographs from a Bring a Trailer auction listing; listing not yet identified.

The report's content agrees with CDB 69-48 and with the surviving dealer tube kit



CONFERENCE REPORT

CLIENT: PONTIAC MOTOR DIVISION

TO: Messrs. J. H. Graham, C. L. Copeland, C. W. Edmonston, R. P. Appold, C. L. Gress, R. E. Benson, J. F. Malone, W. H. Taylor, Jr., E. A. Jones, C. F. Adams, R. E. Britton, C. H. John, E. P. Nemmi, J. Wagers, T. T. Tregarden, W. G. Osborn, J. Smith, A. G. Pabe

TAKE ACTION:

1. "The Judge" Announcement Promotion Package - SA 3091

Presented layouts for the window poster, car ceiling hanger, and car window spec. sheet. All items were approved as presented for inclusion in dealer announcement package with the exception of the car ceiling hanger. This has been dropped from the package due to costs.

Presented price letters covering all items and we are to reprice on the following basis - each Pontiac dealer will receive a shipping tube which will include the following promotion materials:

1. A two-piece announcement window trim measuring 60" x 80" for its main banner. Adjoining this will be a 60" "It's Here" banner.
2. Two car window spec. listings.
3. A 40" x 60" full-color spectacular car picture of The Judge.

This promotion tube will contain an instruction sheet which will show how The Judge announcement poster works with the Hurry Break Away Sale window trim. This instruction sheet is to point out that the dealer is to leave the Break Away Sale window trim on [illegible] in addition to the instruction The Judge poster as an adjoining promotion. In addition to the instruction sheet the tube will contain a roll of Scotch tape for mounting the trim to

shown in Smoke Signals, May 2019, page 16, Tier 3.

Undated

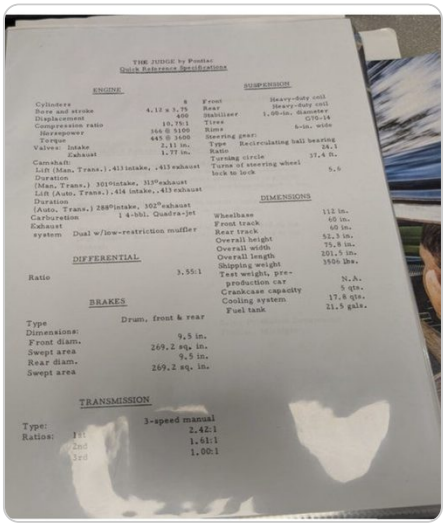
“THE JUDGE by Pontiac Quick Reference Specifications” (filed with Conf. Report 869)

“Test weight, pre-production car N.A.”

Tier 4 · Lead, auction listing photograph, original not examined

Photographs from a Bring a Trailer auction listing; listing not yet identified. Date:

Unresolved



THE JUDGE by Pontiac
Quick Reference Specifications

ENGINE

Cylinders	8
Bore and stroke	4.12 x 3.75
Displacement	400
Compression ratio	10.75:1
Horsepower	366 @ 5100
Torque	445 @ 3600
Valves: Intake	2.11 in.
Exhaust	1.77 in.
Camshaft:	
Lift (Man. Trans.)	.413 intake, .413 exhaust
Duration	
(Man. Trans.)	301° intake, 317° exhaust
Lift (Auto. Trans.)	.414 intake, .413 exhaust
Duration	
(Auto. Trans.)	288° intake, 302° exhaust
Carburetion	1 4-bbl. Quadra-jet
Exhaust system	Dual w/low-restriction muffler

DIFFERENTIAL

Ratio	3.55:1

BRAKES

Type	Drum, front & rear
Dimensions:	
Front diam.	9.5 in.
Swept area	269.2 sq. in.
Rear diam.	9.5 in.
Swept area	269.2 sq. in.

TRANSMISSION

Type:	3-speed manual
Ratios: 1st	2.42:1
2nd	1.61:1
3rd	1.00:1

SUSPENSION

Front	Heavy-duty coil
Rear	Heavy-duty coil
Stabilizer	1.00-in. diameter
Tires	G70-14
Rims	6-in. wide
Steering gear:	
Type	Recirculating ball bearing
Ratio	24:1
Turning circle	37.4 ft.
Turns of steering wheel lock to lock	5.6

DIMENSIONS

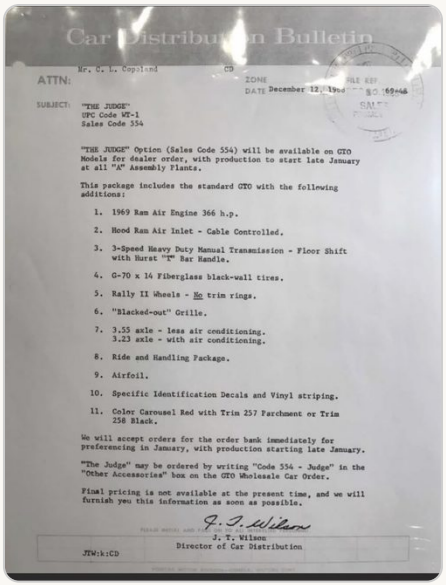
Wheelbase	112 in.
Front track	60 in.
Rear track	60 in.
Overall height	52.3 in.
Overall width	75.8 in.
Overall length	201.5 in.
Shipping weight	3506 lbs.
Test weight, pre-production car	N.A.
Crankcase capacity	5 qts.
Cooling system	17.8 qts.
Fuel tank	21.5 gals.

Dec 12, 1968

Car Distribution Bulletin 69-48, J. T. Wilson

“production to start late January at all ‘A’ Assembly Plants”; “Color Carousel Red with Trim 257 Parchment or Trim 258 Black.”

Tier 2 · **Documented fact**



Car Distribution Bulletin

ATTN: Mr. C. L. Copeland CD

ZONE

DATE December 12, 1968 69-48

SUBJECT: "THE JUDGE"
UPC Code WT-1
Sales Code 554

"THE JUDGE" Option (Sales Code 554) will be available on GTO Models for dealer order, with production to start late January at all "A" Assembly Plants.

This package includes the standard GTO with the following additions:

1. 1969 Ram Air Engine 366 h.p.
2. Hood Ram Air Inlet - Cable Controlled.
3. 3-Speed Heavy Duty Manual Transmission - Floor Shift with Hurst "T" Bar Handle.
4. G-70 x 14 Fiberglass black-wall tires.
5. Rally II Wheels - No trim rings.
6. "Blacked-out" Grille.
7. 3.55 axle - less air conditioning.
   3.23 axle - with air conditioning.
8. Ride and Handling Package.
9. Airfoil.
10. Specific Identification Decals and Vinyl striping.
11. Color Carousel Red with Trim 257 Parchment or Trim 258 Black.

We will accept orders for the order bank immediately for preferencing in January, with production starting late January.

"The Judge" may be ordered by writing "Code 554 - Judge" in the "Other Accessories" box on the GTO Wholesale Car Order.

Final pricing is not available at the present time, and we will furnish you this information as soon as possible.

J. T. Wilson
Director of Car Distribution

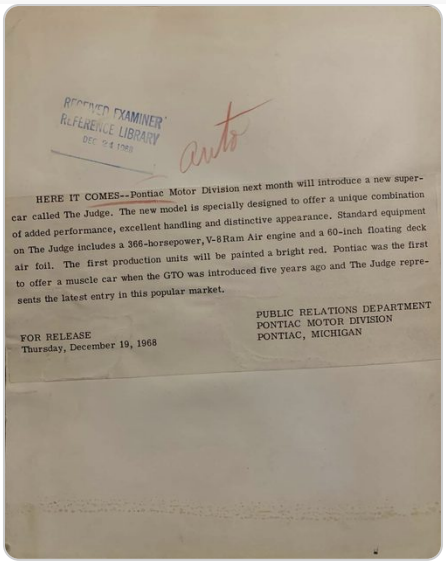
JTW:k:CD

Dec 19, 1968

PMD release (Examiner reference library copy, stamped Dec 24, 1968)

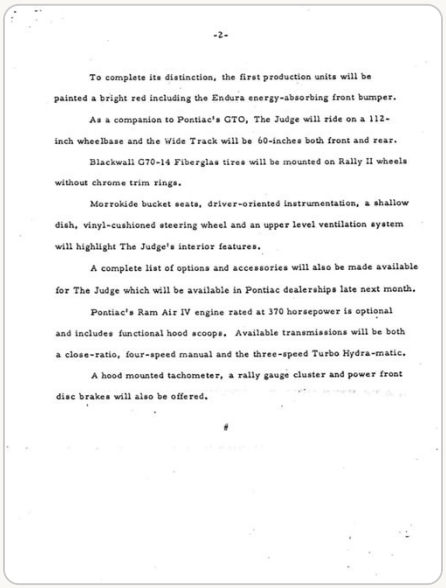
“The first production units

will be painted a bright red."
Tier 2 · **Documented fact**



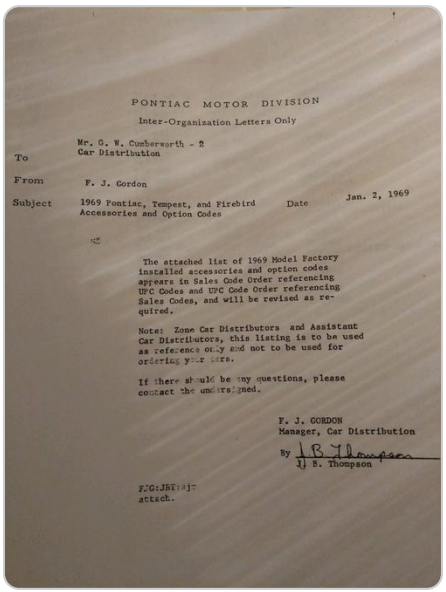
Undated

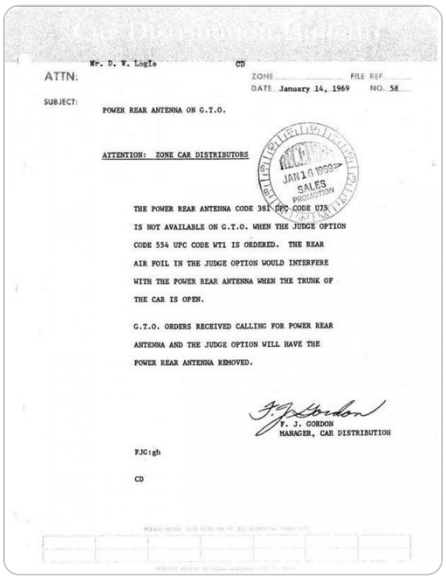
PMD release, page 2 only
"the first production units will be painted a bright red including the Endura energy-absorbing front bumper."
Tier 2 · **Documented fact**
Date: **Unresolved**



Jan 2, 1969

F. J. Gordon letter on accessories and option codes; page "Revisions to Oct. 29th Listing"
"554-WT1 NEW OPTION TEMPEST"
Tier 2 · **Documented fact**
That this page is the letter's attachment rests on owner identification.



Jan 14, 1969	**NEWS FROM PONTIAC price release** “$3,493.02 and $3,719.02 for the convertible.” Tier 2 · **Documented fact**	
Jan 14, 1969	**Car Distribution Bulletin No. 58, F. J. Gordon (rear antenna)** “NOT AVAILABLE ON G.T.O. WHEN THE JUDGE OPTION CODE 554 UPC CODE WT1 IS ORDERED.” Tier 2 · **Documented fact**	
Late Jan 1969 (printed Feb 2, 1969)	**Boston Herald Traveler, “Pontiac ‘Judge’ is Here,” John Rooney** “Twenty five of the new Carousel Red, hardtop coupes were assigned to dealers to be driven to their dealerships.” Tier 3 · **Documented fact** What the article reports; it names no VIN.	

Feb 17, 1969

The Pontiac Press (Pontiac, Mich.), page C-6: retail ad

“The Judge... Now presiding at Pontiac Retail Store, 65 University Drive and E. Wide Track.” The ad lists a 366-hp 400 Ram Air V-8, floor-mounted 3-speed, 60-inch spoiler, mag-type wheels and “blue-red-yellow striping.”

Tier 3 · **Documented fact**

(Tier 3: period newspaper)

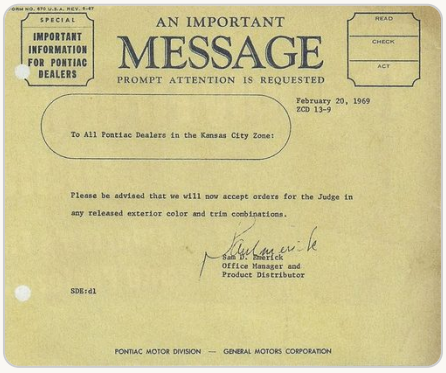


Feb 20, 1969

Kansas City Zone dealer message ZCD 13-9, Sam D. Emerick

“we will now accept orders for the Judge in any released exterior color and trim combinations.”

Tier 2 · **Documented fact**

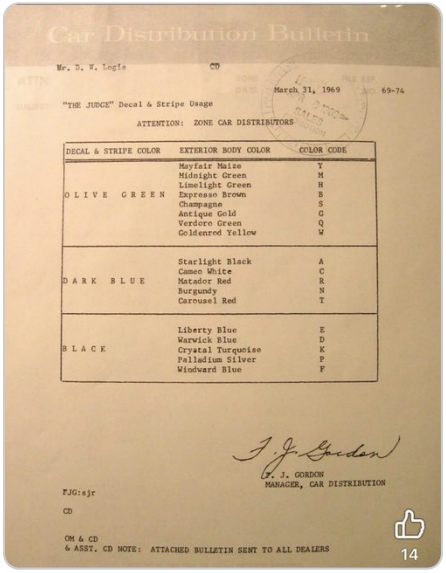


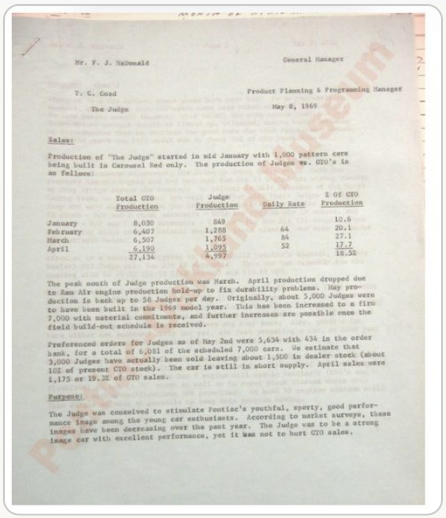
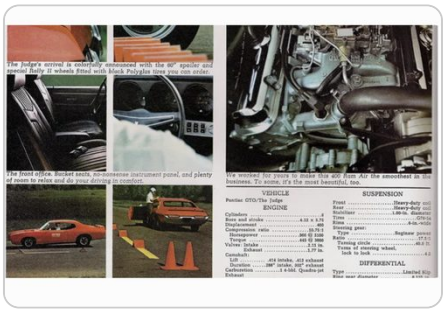
Mar 31, 1969

Car Distribution Bulletin 69-74, F. J. Gordon

“‘THE JUDGE’ Decal & Stripe Usage”

Tier 2 · **Documented fact**



May 8, 1969	**Memo, T. C. Goad to F. J. McDonald, “The Judge” (page 1)** “started in mid January with 1,000 pattern cars being built in Carousel Red only” Tier 2 · **Documented fact**	
Undated (1969 model year)	**Judge sales brochure spread** Lists the 400 Ram Air engine at 366 horsepower at 5100 rpm (paraphrase). Tier 2 · **Documented fact** Date: **Unresolved**	

Not on file: page 1 of the undated release; page 2 of the Goad memo.

AI assistance was used to compile and format this site. Every claim was drawn from Al Diaz's research files and is labeled under his Research Standards & Evidence Policy v1.0. Corrections are welcome and will be dated.

Last updated October 19, 2026. Research by Al Diaz. Labels:

Documented fact **Corroborated interpretation** **Hypothesis** **Unresolved**

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